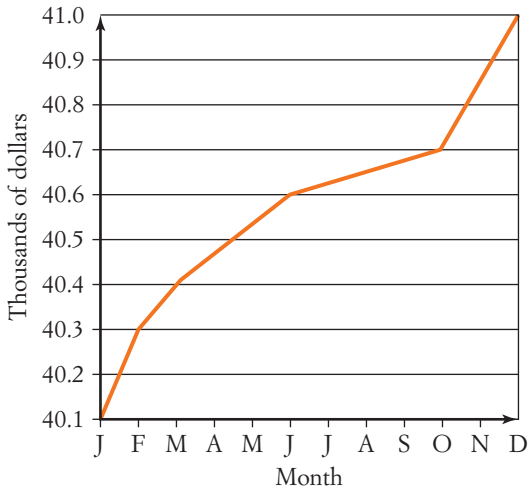
Worksheet

Misleading graphs

Graphs are sometimes used to mislead people and not tell the story as it really is.

1 The Brown Disc company presented the following line graph to show its profits over the year.



a What impression does this graph give?

_____

b What is misleading about this graph?

_____

c Why do you think the company would present this graph?

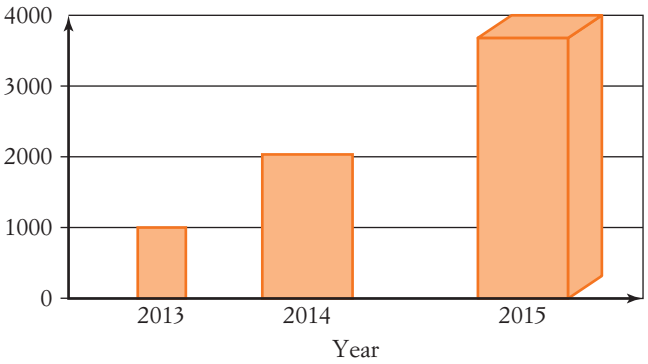
_____

d Draw another graph which truly reflects the profits of this company.

e What does your version of the graph show?

_____

2 This column graph shows the sales of a travel guidebook over three years.



a In what way is this graph misleading?

_____

b Give the number of books sold in:

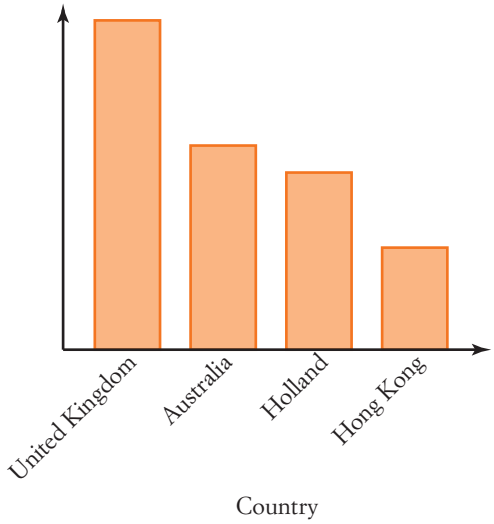
i 2013 _____

ii 2014 _____

iii 2015 _____

© Cengage Learning Australia Pty Ltd 2014

3 This graph shows how much money Japan invests in some countries.



a How is this graph misleading?

_____

b Redraw the graph correctly using these figures:

United Kingdom	$6.8 billion
Australia	$4 billion
Holland	$3.2 billion
Hong Kong	$2 billion

Answers

1 **a** There has been a big increase in profits.

b The vertical scale only goes from 40.1 to 41.

c To impress shareholders etc.

d Teacher to check

e Profits have only increased slightly.

2 **a** Pictures show increased area rather than length as in a column.

b **i** 1000 **ii** 2000 **iii** 4000

3 **a** No vertical scale

b Teacher to check